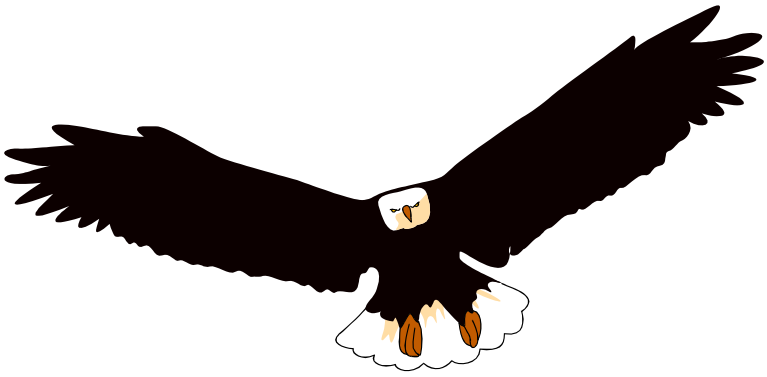
Life's Tools

As Utilized By Successful People



By

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Chapter 1

Overcoming Obstacles

We achieve to the degree that we overcome the negative. Conquerors are willing to pay the price necessary to overcome anything that stands in their way. They sacrifice, struggle, work continuously while being alone, weary, and discouraged. They overcome the negative despite all obstacles. Overcoming obstacles is simply one tool required in the work shed of successful people.

Success can be measured by the magnitude of the obstacles which have been overcome to achieve it. Not by the rank you have obtained in your chosen field.

The more insurmountable the obstacle that has been surmounted, the more successful the accomplishment.

Life's tools are, in all cases, found within ourselves and must be searched for and obtained at all costs. Effort is required of the seeker and honor is bestowed on the sweat. If there were no obstacles to overcome, would there be as much sense of accomplishment? If there were no effort required, would there be as much satisfaction in acquiring the success seeked?

Important in life is to overcome, success is secondary. Inherent in life is the desire to give everything you've got - to conquer is secondary. If too much emphasis is placed on winning then too much focus is taken away from the effort you can place into the work at hand.

Chapter 2

Superiority

We gain the advantage in any situation through the use of the tools we have at hand. We gain the advantage by utilizing the tools to accomplish things before they need to be done - positioning, planning, working, desiring, focusing, reasoning, learning, ... Those who plan ahead of the approaching action will have the advantage. They will be the winners.

The key to winning a circumstance is to take advantage of opportunity before problems present themselves. Why wait for a flood to repair a levy?

If we do everything that is necessary, then how can we be at a disadvantage to someone without that conviction?

Why worry when we can better utilize your mind's focus with thinking and planning ahead.

You can tell a lot about a man by the way he handles himself in unfavorable circumstances.

Chapter 3

Attitude

We have control of our attitude. How we respond to circumstance is determines our attitude. The circumstance itself should not control our attitude, else we become manipulated like puppets by the environment. Our minds strongly determine the control we allow ourselves over our attitude. We can respond positively with self control or negatively with anger. It's how we react to situations, not the situations themselves, that influences our attitude. Environment only influences us to the point that we allow it to influence us.

Your life is judged not so much by what happens to you as by the attitude you display the face of what happens. Your mental picture of the environment is the determining factor in the control you have over yourself and others.

One truism about bad feelings often goes unnoticed. We cause them to occur, not the environment. An external dilemma presents the challenge to us and waits for a reaction. So we must concern ourselves with our reactions instead of the circumstances involved.

What happens to you is not a function of power but what happens inside your mind and within your reactive control is a function of your power as a man. This is very evident in the world of sports today with younger and younger athletes obtaining more and more money and fame which they mistake for power. Then they show how much true power they have in their reaction to unfavorable circumstances. In life there are two dominant forces, external and internal. We have very little control over external phenomenon such as the way our coach coaches, the way the referee makes a call, the way an opposing athlete plays us, etc.. What really shows the character of the man is the internal reaction. How do we respond to those predicaments? Over that we have complete and utter control.

No one can make you do anything, you have control within yourself. The problem is not the other person; it is the way you behave to the other person.

External phenomenon can't make you poor, only without money. Being poor is an internal mindset. Being without money

is only an external situation.

Life at any time can take fateful twists and turns.
Winning the race of life depends on how you respond to whatever twists and turns you must make to stay on the right track.

You can't always control your environment, but you can always control your attitude.



Chapter 4

Law of Averages

This is the law of averages; the more we fail,
the greater our chance of succeeding. Failure is often
the first necessary step toward success. And if we
don't take the risk of failing, we won't get the chance
to succeed. When we are trying, we are winning.

Many a one has finally succeeded only because he has
failed after repeated efforts. If he had never met
defeat he would never have known any great victory.

The men who try to do something and fail are infinitely
better than those who try to do nothing and succeed.

I am not judged by the number of times I fail, but by
the number of times I succeed; and the number of times
I succeed is in direct proportion to the number of
times I can fail and keep on trying.

The success always has a number of projects planned,
to which he looks forward. Any one of them could change
the course of his life overnight.

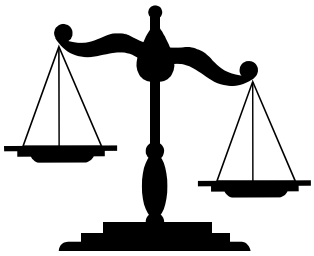
What is defeat? Nothing but education, nothing but
the first step to do something better.

We learn wisdom from failure much more than from
success. We often discover what will do, by finding
out what will not do; and probably he who never made
a mistake never made a discovery.

It is a mistake to suppose that men succeed through
success; they much oftener succeed through failures ....
Precept, study, advice, and example could never
have taught them so well as failure has done.

Would you like me to give you a formula for...success?
It's quite simple, really. Double your rate of failure....
You're thinking of failure as the enemy of success.
But it isn't at all...You can be discouraged by failure-
or you can learn from it. So go ahead and make mistakes.

Make all you can. Because, remember that's where you'll find success. On the far side of failure.



Chapter 5

Heart

Having heart is the knowledge that we can do something.
It's the inner feeling that what we undertake, we can
accomplish. For the most part, all of us have the ability
to look at something and to know whether or not we can
do it. So in confidence, there is power: our eyes are opened;
our opportunities become evident; our visions become realities.

Do not take for granted the things closest to your heart.
Cling to them as you would your life, for without them, life is meaningless.

Whether you think you can or think you can't - you are right.

You have a remarkable ability which you never acknowledged
before. It is to look at a situation and know whether you
can do it. And I mean really know the answer....

The only thing that stands between a man and what he
wants from life is often merely the will to try it
and the faith to believe that it is possible.

You can do anything you think you can. This knowledge
is literally the gift of the gods, for through it you
can solve every human problem. It should make of you
an incurable optimist. It is the open door....

The mind is the limit. As long as the mind can envision
the fact that you can do something, you can do it - as
long as you really believe with 1OO percent of your being.

The barrier between....success is not something which
exists in the real world; it is composed purely and
simply of....doubts about....ability.

These, then, are my last words to you; Be not afraid
of life. Believe that life is worth living and your
belief will help create the fact.



Chapter 6

Selection

Our greatest power is the power to choose. We can decide where we are, what we do, and what we think. No one can take the power to choose away from us. It is ours alone. We can do what we want to do. We can be who we want to be.

You are searching for the magic key that will unlock the door to the source of power; and yet you have the key in your own hands, and you may make use of it the moment you learn to control your thoughts.

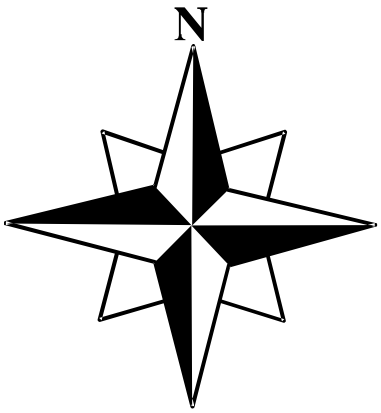
You can at any time decide to alter the course of your life - no one can take that away. Any person can choose to activate real directions of the self. It is true for every individual that at any moment he can choose to become himself.

Nature is at work. Character and destiny are her handiwork. She gives us love and hate, jealousy and reverence. All that is ours is the power to choose which impulse we shall follow.

We stand at the helm and know that we are captains of our fate and not a slave of fate - reaper of our joys and gardener of our sorrows.

A man sooner or later discovers that he himself is the master-keeper of his soul, the director of his life.

It is always your next move.



Chapter 7

Situation

We can know what people are thinking by looking at what they do. Actions mirror thoughts. And by taking a good look at where we are and what we are doing, we can understand what we are thinking. The thoughts we have chosen have brought us where we are today.

Every man is where he is by the law of his being; the thoughts which he has built into his character have brought him there.

How we think shows through in how we act. Attitudes are mirrors of the mind. They reflect thinking.

As I grow older, I pay less attention to what men say. I just watch what they do.

You can preach a better sermon with your life than with your lips.

By the work one knows the workman.

Chapter 8

Optimism

This is the law of optimism: Every negative has a positive. We cannot have the good without the bad. With every loss comes a gain. And within every difficulty, there's an opportunity. Seeing success where others see only failure may be the one thing that pushes us on to victory.

Polarity, or action and reaction, we meet in every part of nature; in darkness and light; in heat and cold; in the ebb and flow of waters; in male and female; in the inspiration and expiration of plants and animals; in the equation of quantity and quality, in the fluids of the animal body, in the systole and diastole of the heart.

Every failure brings with it the seed of an equivalent success.

In every adversity there lies the seed of an equivalent advantage. In every defeat there is a lesson showing you how to win the victory next time.

I always tried to turn every disaster into an opportunity.

Even a mistake may turn out to be the one thing necessary to a worthwhile achievement.

Never walk away from failure. On the contrary, study it carefully - and imaginatively - for its hidden assets.

Develop success from failures. Discouragement and failure are two of the surest stepping stones to success. No other element can do so much for a man if he is willing to study them and make capital out of them.

Two men look out through the same bars:
One sees the mud, and one the stars.

Sometimes a step back is the best way to go two steps forward.

Chapter 9

Focus

Concentration is the magic key that opens the door
to accomplishment. By concentrating our efforts
upon a few major goals, our efficiency soars, our
projects are completed - we are going somewhere. By focusing
our efforts to a single point, we achieve the greatest results.

The first rule of success, and the one that supersedes
all others, is to have energy. It is important to know
how to concentrate it, how to husband it, how to focus
it on important things instead of frittering it away on trivia.

Singleness of purpose is one of the chief essentials
for success in life, no matter what may be one's aim.

The giants of the race have been men of concentration,
who have struck sledge-hammer blows in one place until
they have accomplished their purpose. The successful
men of today are men of one overmastering idea, one
unwavering aim, men of single and intense purpose.

Concentration is the key to economic results....
no other principle of effectiveness is violated
as constantly today as the basic principle of
concentration....Our motto seems to be: Let's
do a little bit of everything.

The jack-of-all trades seldom is good at any.
Concentrate all of your efforts on one definite chief aim.

What do I mean by concentration? I mean focusing
totally on the business at hand and commanding your
body to do exactly what you want it to do.

When every physical and mental resource is focused,
one's power to solve a problem multiplies tremendously.



Chapter 10

Practice

The secret to becoming self-confident is preparation.
By practicing we come to a point of competence.
We find ourselves accomplishing our goals gracefully
and confidently. It is then that we do things that we never
dreamed we could do. We discover powers we never knew existed.

Confidence doesn't come out of nowhere. It's a
result of something .... hours and days and weeks
and years of constant work and dedication.

What I do is prepare myself until I know I can do what I have to do.

For years I have been accused of making snap judgments. Honestly, this is not the case because I am a profound military student and the thoughts I express, perhaps too flippantly, are the results of years of thought and study.

I've learned that I still have a lot to learn.

Chapter 11

Self Control

We have self control to the degree that we make the decisions. To affect the outcome of anything, we must control conflict at the point of decision making. Two sides of an argument often involve the intellectual versus the emotional.

Reason and emotion are not antagonists. What seems like a struggle is a struggle between two opposing ideas or values, one of which, automatic and unconscious, manifests itself in the form of a feeling.

In the end, we do battle only with ourselves. Once we understand this and focus our energy on what we can do to control our lives .... we begin to gain important insights into how life works.

Man masters nature not by force but by understanding.

It is part of our pedagogy to teach the operations of thinking, feeling, and willing so that they may be made conscious. For if we do not know the difference between an emotion and a thought, we will know very little .... We need to understand the components [of emotions] at work .... in order to free their hold.

A clear understanding of negative emotions dismisses them.

We must become acquainted with our emotional household; we must see our feelings as they actually are, not as we assume they are. This breaks their hypnotic and damaging hold on us.

To be conscious that you are ignorant is a great step to knowledge.

The strong man is the one who is able to intercept at will the communication between the senses and the mind.

He who would be useful, strong, and happy, must cease to be a passive receptacle for the negative, beggarly, and impure streams of thought; and as a wise householder commands his servants and invites his guests, so must he learn to command his desires, and to say, with authority, what thoughts he shall admit into the mansion of his soul.

Chapter 12

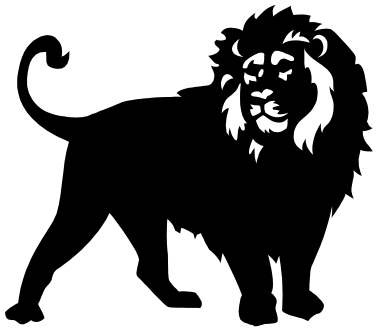
Control Direction

If we let others make decisions for us,
we have no control. When we control the decisions,
we control the actions. The best decisions
are the ones made with appropriate forethought on
how they affect us. Others seldom think
for you in that manner.

If you don't run your own life, somebody else will.

Sometimes if you want to see a change for the better,
you have to take things into your own hands.

You can tell a lot about a man by the way he handles
unfavorable circumstances



Chapter 13

Relationships

We gain what we want through teamwork and our relationship with others. To be agreeable, to be liked, to cooperate - this contributes immeasurably to our success.
When we coordinate our efforts with the efforts of others, we speed the way to our goals. Cooperation builds success.

It is a fragile thread that binds us to each other.

You cannot continuously improve interdependent systems and processes until you progressively perfect interdependent, interpersonal relationships.

The world basically and fundamentally is constituted on the basis of harmony. Everything works in cooperation with something else.

No employer today is independent of those about him. He cannot succeed alone, no matter how great his ability or capital. Business today is more than ever a question of cooperation.

Personal relationships are the fertile soil from
which all advancement, all success, all achievement
in real life grows.

If your imagination leads you to understand how
quickly people grant your requests when those requests
appeal to their self-interest, you can have practically
anything you go after.

Put yourself in the other man's place, and then you
will know why he thinks certain things and does
certain deeds.

How strange is the lot of us mortals! Each of us
is here for a brief sojourn; for what purpose he knows
not, though he senses it. But without deeper reflection
one knows from daily life that one exists for other
people.

Coming together is a beginning;
Keeping together is progress;
Working together is success.



Chapter 14

Valor

Courage is the power to face difficulties. It's the opposite of being dis*couraged*. Courage comes from a reserve of mind more powerful than outside circumstance. When we are bigger than our problems, we gain the courage necessary to win.

Nothing splendid has ever been achieved except by those who dared believe that something inside of them was superior to circumstance.

Man is not the creature of circumstances,
circumstances are the creatures of men.
We are free agents, and man is more powerful
than matter.

Victory becomes, to some degree, a state of mind. Knowing ourselves superior to the anxieties, troubles, and worries which obsess us, we are superior to them.

Courage is a special kind of knowledge; the knowledge of how to fear what ought to be feared and how not to fear what ought not to be feared.

The beauty of the soul shines out when a man bears
with composure one heavy mischance after another,
not because he does not feel them, but because he is
a man of high and heroic temper.

Chapter 15

Cumulative Results

Rome was never built in a day but over time.
Progress begins a step at a time. There is no sudden
leap to greatness. Our success lies in focus on only the next step.
Success then becomes habit forming by working consistently well.
Continuous good work on a project becomes a great work.
The house of success is built brick by brick.

Progress, however, of the best kind, is comparatively
slow. Great results cannot be achieved at once;
and we must be satisfied to advance in life as we walk,
step by step.

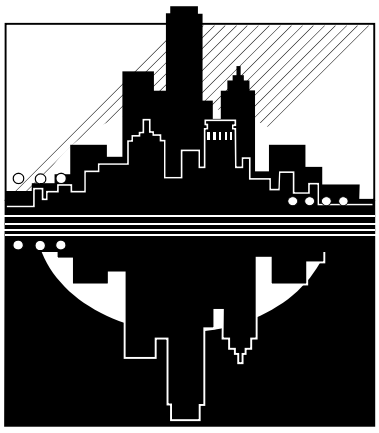
The most successful men in the end are those whose
success is the result of steady accretion .... It is
the man who carefully advances step by step, with his
mind becoming wider and wider, - and progressively
better able to grasp any theme or situation, -
persevering in what he knows to be practical, and
concentrating his thought upon it, who is bound
to succeed in the greatest degree.

The person determined to achieve maximum success
learns the principle that progress is made one step
at a time. A house is built a brick at a time.
Football games are won a play at a time. A department

store grows bigger one customer at a time. Every
big accomplishment is a series of little accomplishments.

All great masters are chiefly distinguished by the
power of adding a second, a third, and perhaps a fourth
step in a continuous line. Many a man had taken the
first step. With every additional step you enhance
immensely the value of your first.

Let this be understood, then, at starting; that
the patient conquest of difficulties which rise in
the regular and legitimate channels of business and
enterprise is not only essential in securing the
success which you seek but it is essential to that
preparation of your mind, requisite for the enjoyment
of your successes, and for retaining them when
gained .... So, day by day, and week by week; so,
month after month, and year after year, work on,
and in that process gain strength and symmetry,
and nerve and knowledge, that when success,
patiently and bravely worked for, shall come,
it may find you prepared to receive it and keep it.



Chapter 16

Periodicity

Events tend to repeat themselves. The tide of opportunity comes to us all. And when we are prepared for opportunity, our chance is sure to come. Success depends upon more than being at the right place at the right time - it depends upon being ready.

Be ready when opportunity comes .... Luck is the time when preparation and opportunity meet.

Wealth is in applications of the mind to nature; and the art of getting rich consists not in industry, much less in saving, but in a better order, in timeliness, in being at the right spot.

Unless you have prepared yourself to profit by your chance, the opportunity will only make you ridiculous. A great occasion is valuable to you just in proportion as you have educated yourself to make use of it.

Take a second look at what appears to be someone's good luck. You'll find not luck but preparation, planning, and success-producing thinking ....

Chapter 17

Will Power

There is a key which, if properly utilized and understood, will allow us to achieve results that may seem unobtainable - the key is desire. A baby elephant, tied to a tree with a large rope, pulls at the rope unable to break free despite his desire. Then as the elephant grows large he can be tied to the same tree with the same rope, and he never even tries to break the rope again even though he could easily break the rope with his present strength. The elephant owners broke the elephant's desire to put out any effort towards breaking the rope. If we do not allow anyone or anything to break our desire - we can gain the strength we need to accomplish anything. If we want something badly enough, we are sure to get it. If we have the desire, we have the power.

Where there is no power .... there is never any desire to do a thing; and where there is strong desire to do a thing .... the power to do it is strong.

It sometimes seems that intense desire creates not only its own opportunities, but its own talents.

When your desires are strong enough you will appear to possess superhuman powers to achieve.

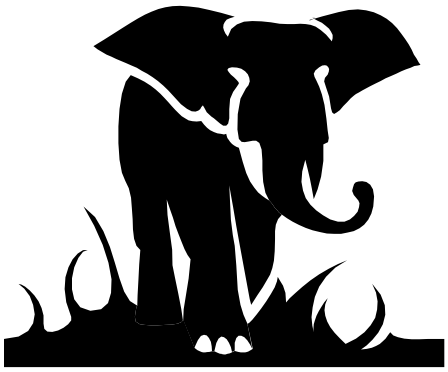
Nothing stops the man who desires to achieve. Every obstacle is simply a course to develop his achievement muscle. It's a strengthening of his powers of accomplishment.

Ignore what a man desires and you ignore the very source of his power ....

The greatest trouble with most of us is that our demands upon ourselves are so feeble, the call upon the great within of us so weak and intermittent that it makes no impression upon the creative energies; it lacks the force that transmutes desire into realities.

You know from past experience that whenever you have been driven to the wall, or thought you were, you have extricated yourself in a way which you never would have dreamed possible had you not been put to the test. The trouble is that in your everyday life you don't go deep enough to tap the divine mind within you.

The longer I live, the more I am certain that the great difference between men, between the weak and the powerful, between the great and the insignificant, is energy - invincible determination - a purpose once fixed means either death or victory.



Chapter 18

Pleasure

If we enjoy what we do, we will be successful.
If we do not enjoy what we do, we will not be successful.

Our success in any occupation depends upon enjoyment. Loving our work makes the difference. He who finds joy in his work, has found success at last.

Do not run through life
so fast that you forget
not only where you have been,
but also where you are going.
Life is not a race, but a journey
to be savored each step of the way.

What you do is more important than how much you make, and how you feel about it is more important than what you do.

If you do not feel yourself growing in your work and your life broadening and deepening, if your task is not a perpetual tonic to you, you have not found your place.

Get into a line that you will find to be a deep personal interest, something you really enjoy spending twelve to fifteen hours a day working at, and the rest of the time thinking about.

Success in its highest and noblest form calls for peace of mind and enjoyment and happiness which come only to the man who has found the work that he likes best.

The man who does not work for the love of work but only for money is not likely to make money nor to find much fun in life.

I never did a day's work in my life. It was all fun.

If you want happiness, make sure the ones
around you are happy too.

You can make someone's day simply by sending
them a little card.

I've learned that if you pursue happiness, it will elude you.
But if you focus on your family, the needs of others, your work,
meeting new people, and doing the very best you can,
happiness will find you.

Chapter 19

Environment

We become like our environment, and our environment
becomes like us. Everything around us molds and shapes us.
So it is important to choose our environment with care:
one that is positive, one that lifts us up and gives
us wings to soar.

Every experience in life, everything with which we have come in contact in life, is a chisel which has been cutting away at our life statue, molding, modifying, shaping it. We are part of all we have met. Everything we have seen, heard, felt or thought has had its hand in molding us, shaping us.

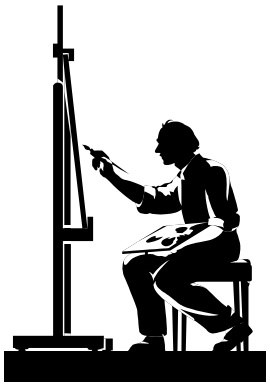
You are a product of your environment. So choose the environment that will best develop you toward your objective. Analyze your life in terms of its environment. Are the things around you helping you toward success- or are they holding you back?

Your outlook upon life, your estimate of yourself, your estimate of your value are largely colored by your environment. Your whole career will be modified, shaped, molded by your surroundings, by the character of the people with whom you come in contact every day ...

We begin to see, therefore, the importance of selecting our environment with the greatest of care, because environment is the mental feeding ground out of which the food that goes into our minds is extracted.

A strong, successful man is not the victim of his environment. He creates favorable conditions. His own inherent force and energy compel things to turn out as he desires.

When I get my room the way I like it, Mom makes me clean it up.



Chapter 20

Perfection

Going far beyond the call of duty, doing more than others expect - this is what excellence is all about. And it comes from striving, maintaining the highest standards, looking after the smallest detail, and going the extra mile. Excellence means caring - it means making a special effort to do more.

To do the right thing, at the right time, in the right way; to do some things better than they were ever done before; to eliminate errors; to know both sides of the question; to be courteous; to be an example; to work for the love of work; to anticipate

requirements; to develop resources; to recognize no impediments; to master circumstances; to act from reason rather than rule; to be satisfied with nothing short of perfection.

Put the uncommon effort into the common task .... make it large by doing it in a great way.

You can start right where you stand and apply the habit of going the extra mile by rendering more service and better service than you are now being paid for ....

I start where the last man left off.

The man who comes up with a means for doing or producing almost anything better, faster or more economically has his future and his fortune at his fingertips.

There's a way to do it better .... find it.

It is just the little difference between the good and the best that makes the difference between the artist and the artisan. It is just the little touches after the average man would quit that make the master's fame.



Chapter 21

Belief

Be careful what you wish for you just might obtain it. To feel in our innermost being that we will achieve what we set out to do - this opens the way for miracles. Expecting something to happen energizes our goal and gives it momentum. We often find that life responds to our outlook. What we expect to happen, happens. The dreams we choose to believe in come to be.

Life .... It tends to respond to our outlook,
to shape itself to meet our expectations.

For, he that expects nothing shall not be disappointed, but he that expects much - if he lives and uses that in hand day by day - shall be full to running over.

Think and feel yourself there! To achieve any aim in life, you need to project the end-result .... Think of the elation, the satisfaction, the joy! Carrying the ecstatic feeling will bring the desired goal into view.

In order to win, you must expect to win.

Chapter 22

Accepting Risk

Successful people are not afraid to fail. They accept the risk and continue on, knowing that failure is a natural consequence of trying. They go from failure to failure, until at last success is theirs. Accepting risk is one of the most powerful of all rules for success: we fail only when we can't accept failure.

Do not give up when you still have something to give. Nothing is really over until the moment you stop trying.

Do not be afraid to encounter risks. It is by taking chances that we learn how to be brave.

The wise man realistically accepts failure as a part of life and builds a philosophy to meet them and make the most of them. He lives on the principle of nothing attempted, nothing gained and is resolved that if he fails he is going to fail while trying to succeed.

To fail is a natural consequence of trying. To succeed takes time and prolonged effort in the

face of unfriendly odds. To think it will be any other way, no matter what you do, is to invite yourself to be hurt and to limit your enthusiasm for trying again.

Failure is success if we learn from it.

Not many people are willing to give failure a second opportunity. They fail once and it's all over. The bitter pill of failure .... is often more than most people can handle .... If you're willing to accept failure and learn from it, if you're willing to consider failure as a blessing in disguise and bounce back, you've got the potential of harnessing one of the most powerful success forces.

When defeat comes, accept it as a signal that your plans are not sound, rebuild those plans, and set sail once more toward your coveted goal.

Failure is only the opportunity to more intelligently begin again.

The credit belongs to the man who is actually in the arena; whose face is marred by dust and sweat and blood; who strives valiantly; who errs and comes short again and again; who knows the great enthusiasms, the great devotions, and spends himself in a worthy cause; who at the best knows in the end the triumph of high achievement; and who at the worst, if he fails, at least fails while daring greatly ....



Chapter 23

Trust

Trust is based upon something - the evidence of things not seen. To have faith, we must have evidence. Trust is not blind. We can know the invisible by seeing the visible. We can see the trees bend and know there is wind. We can see the moon reflect light and know the sun is shinning. We can see man, and know there is something beyond.

The supernatural is the natural not yet understood.

Who has seen the wind?

It is only with the heart that one can see correctly;

what is essential is invisible to the eye.

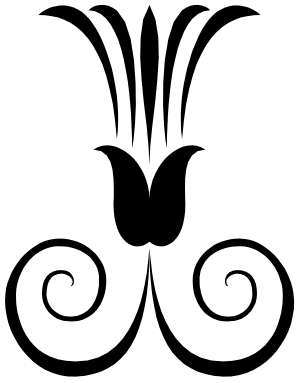
The thing that is incredible is life itself ....
Why should we be here in this sun-illuminated universe?
Why should there be green earth under our feet?

Seeing, hearing, feeling, are miracles, and each
part and tag of me is a miracle.

The miracles of nature do not seem miracles because
they are so common. If no one had ever seen a flower,
even a dandelion would be the most startling event
in the world.

I know this world is ruled by infinite intelligence ....
Everything that surrounds us - everything that exists -
proves that there are infinite laws behind it. There
can be no denying this fact. It is mathematical in
its precision.

I think therefore I am. (I have a soul)



Chapter 24

Conquering Fear

Fear is conquered by action. When we challenge our fears,
we defeat them. When we grapple with our difficulties,
they lose their hold upon us. When we dare to face the
things which scare us, we open the door to freedom.

Do not give up when you still have something to give.
Nothing is really over until the moment you stop trying.

Do the thing you fear to do and keep on doing it ....
that is the quickest and surest way ever yet discovered to conquer fear.

To fight fear, act. To increase fear - wait, put off, postpone, procrastinate.

Whenever we're afraid, its because we don't know
enough. If we understood enough, we would never be afraid.

You are only afraid if you are not in harmony with yourself. People are afraid because they have never owned up to themselves.

Far better it is to dare mighty things, to win glorious triumphs, even though checkered by failure, than to rank with those poor souls who neither enjoy much nor suffer much, because they live in the gray twilight that knows neither victory nor defeat.

Chapter 25

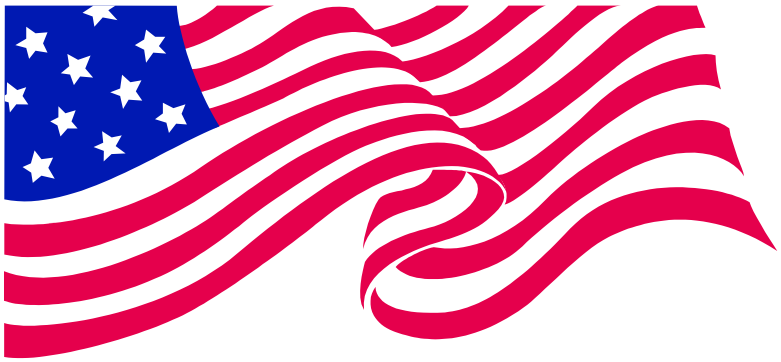
Independence

Freedom is the courage to sacrifice for what we want. And everything we want has a price. There's a price for every freedom, something to be given up for every liberty. It's up to us to weigh the price we must pay for each of our freedoms.

Whatever the price, identify it now. What will you have to go through to get where you want to be? .... There is a price you can pay to be free of the situation once and for all. It may be a fantastic price or a tiny one - but there is a price.

You are free to do whatever you like. You need only face the consequences.

Men are not prisoners of fate, but only prisoners of their own minds.



Chapter 26

Satisfaction

Riches lie within us, not in material possessions.
Our real riches are riches of the head and heart.
Satisfaction comes from appreciating what we have.
Wealth without enjoyment is little consolation.
Our real prosperity lies in being thankful.

There are two ways of being happy; we must either
diminish our wants or augment our means ....

People want riches; they need fulfillment.

It is not the man who has little, but the man
who craves more, that is poor.

Getting anything changes it from being desirable
to just being taken for granted.

Money is a good servant, but a poor master.

Don't forget until too late that the business of
life is not business, but living.

There is a serious defect in the thinking of someone
who wants - more than anything else - to become rich.
As long as they don't have the money, it'll seem like
a worthwhile goal. Once they do, they'll understand
how important other things are - and have always been.

Money cannot buy peace of mind. It cannot heal
ruptured relationships, or build meaning into a life that has none.

The only thing money gives you is the freedom of not worrying about money.



Chapter 27

Generosity

It's a universal law - we have to give before we receive. We must plant the seeds before we reap the harvest. The more we sow, the more we reap. And in giving to others, we find ourselves blessed. The law works to give us back more than we have sown. The giver's harvest is always full.

There would be no advantage to be gained by sowing a field of wheat if the harvest did not return more than was sown.

The best thing about giving of ourselves is that what we get is always better than what we give. The reaction is greater than the action.

The man who will use his skill and constructive
imagination to see how much he can give for a dollar,
instead of how little he can give for a dollar,
is bound to succeed.

Life sometimes gives you a second chance.

You shouldn't go through life with a catchers mitt on
both hands. You need to be able to throw something back.

Chapter 28

Goals

The purpose of goals is to focus our attention.
The mind will not reach toward achievement until
it has clear objectives. The magic begins when we
set goals. It is then that the switch is turned on, the current
begins to flow, and the power to accomplish becomes a reality.

Do not set your goals by what other people deem important.
Only you know what is best for you.

There is one quality which one must possess to win,
and that is definiteness of purpose, the knowledge of
what one wants, and a burning desire to possess it.

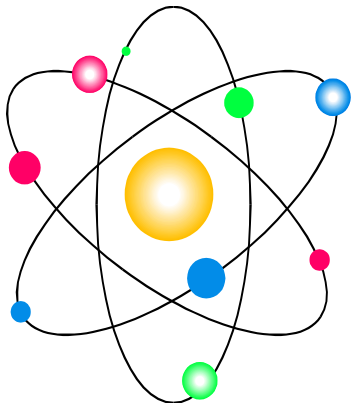
Until input (thought) is linked to a goal (purpose)
there can be no intelligent accomplishment.

This one step - choosing a goal and sticking to it - changes everything.

If you don't know where you are going, any road will get you there.

The world has the habit of making room for the man whose words and actions show that he knows where he is going.

What an immense power over the life is the power of possessing distinct aims. The voice, the dress, the look, the very motions of a person, define and alter when he or she begins to live for a reason.



Chapter 29

Development

Development is the process of responding to change. Grappling with hardships, trouble, and calamity; facing adversity in a spirit of determination and courage; loving and not being crushed by broken hopes; holding our head high, having done our best - this is true development to a higher level.

The very greatest things - great thoughts, discoveries, inventions - have usually been nurtured in hardship, often pondered over in sorrow, and at length established with difficulty.

The gem cannot be polished without friction, nor man perfected without trials.

Close scrutiny will show that most ... crisis situations are ... opportunities to either advance, or stay where you are.

What happens is not as important as how you react to what happens.

Life is my college.

Events will take their course, it is no good our being angry at them; he is happiest who wisely turns them to the best account.

Life is a series of experiences, each one of which makes us bigger, even though sometimes it is hard to realize this. For the world was built to develop character, and we must learn that the setbacks and grieves which we endure help us in our marching onward.

I am convinced that the world is not a mere bog in which men and women trample themselves in the mire and die. Something magnificent is taking place here amid the cruelties and tragedies, and the supreme challenge to intelligence is that of making the noblest and best in our curious heritage prevail.

The sculptor will chip off all unnecessary material to set free the angel. Nature will chip and pound us remorselessly to bring out our possibilities. She will strip us of wealth, humble our pride, humiliate our ambition, let us down from the ladder of fame, will discipline us in a thousand ways, if she can develop a little character. Everything must give way to that. Wealth is nothing, position is nothing, fame is nothing, manhood is everything.

Chapter 30

Routine

The force of habit can be swift to push us to failure or to success. The more we do something, the more likely we are to do it again. Habit is like a mountain - once built it takes much effort to change its configuration.

Habit, my friend, is practice long pursued, that at last becomes the man himself.

The more deeply the path is etched, the more it is used, and the more it is used, the more deeply it is etched.

The more one works, the more willing one is to work.

The beginning of a habit is like an invisible thread, but every time we repeat the act we strengthen the strand, add to it another filament, until it becomes a great cable and binds us irrevocably thought and act.

The individual who wants to reach the top in business must appreciate the might of the force of habit - and must understand that practices are what create habits. He must be quick to

break those habits that can break him -
and hasten to adopt those practices that will become
the habits that help him achieve the success he desires.

Habits ... the only reason they persist is that
they are offering some satisfaction ... You allow
them to persist by not seeking any other, better
form of satisfying the same needs. Every habit,
good or bad, is acquired and learned in the
same way - by finding that it is a means of
satisfaction.

Thoughts lead on to purpose; purposes go forth
in action; action form habits; habits decide
character; and character fixes our destiny.



Chapter 31

Contentment

We are happy when we are utilizing our potential.
Striving against difficulties and overcoming
them - reaching for achievement and finding
it - this is happiness. We are happy when we
are learning, growing, and accomplishing.
Working toward a worthy goal that demands our
best is the secret of happiness.

Happiness is the full use of your powers along
lines of excellence in a life affording scope.

Happiness does not come from doing easy work
but from the afterglow of satisfaction that comes after the
achievement of a difficult task that demanded our best.

What a man really wants is creative challenge
with sufficient skills to bring him within the reach of success
so that he may have the expanding joy of achievement.

Do you want my one-word secret of happiness?
It's growth - mental, financial, you name it.

One might think that the money value of an invention
constitutes its reward to the man who loves his work.
But, speaking for myself, I can honestly say this is not so ...
I continue to find my greatest pleasure, and so my reward,
in the work that precedes what the world calls success.

We find greatest joy, not in getting, but in
expressing what we are ... Men do not really live

for honors or pay; their gladness is not in the taking and holding, but in the doing, the striving, the building, the living. It is a higher joy to teach than to be taught. It is good to get justice, but better to do it; fun to have things but more to make them. The happy man is he who lives the life of love, not for the honors it may bring, but for the life itself.

There is joy in work ... There is no happiness except in the realization that we have accomplished something.



Chapter 32

Honesty

Before us lie two paths - honesty and dishonesty.
The shortsighted embark on the dishonest path;
the wise on the honest. For the wise know the truth;
in helping others we help ourselves; and in hurting
others we hurt ourselves. Character overshadows money,
and trust rises above fame. Honesty is still the best policy.

Understand this law and you will then know, beyond
room for the slightest doubt, that you are constantly
punishing yourself for every wrong you commit and
rewarding yourself for every act of constructive
conduct in which you indulge.

Everyone will experience the consequences of his
own acts. If his acts are right, he'll get good
consequences; if they're not, he'll suffer for it.

It is better to deserve honors and not have them
than to have them and not deserve them.

It is the eternal struggle between these two
principles - right and wrong ... They are the
two principles that have stood face to face from the
beginning of time and will ever continue to struggle ...
It is the same spirit that says, “You work and toil
and earn bread while I eat it.”

There are always two choices. Two paths to take.
One is easy. And its only reward is that it's easy.

It is easy to hate and it is difficult to love.

This is how the whole scheme of things works.
All good things are difficult to achieve; and bad
things are very easy to get.

Badness you can get easily, in quantity; the road
is smooth, and it lies close by. But in front of
excellence the immortal gods have put sweat, and
long and steep is the way to it.



Chapter 33

Imagination

Seeing all the possibilities, seeing all that can
be done, and how it can be done, marks the power
of imagination. Our imagination is our own personal
laboratory. Here we can recreate events, map out
plans, and visualize overcoming obstacles.
Imagination shows us how to turn possibility into reality.

Visualize this thing that you want. See it, feel it,
believe in it. Make your mental blue print, and begin to build.

The imagination equips us to perceive reality when it
is not fully materialized.

First comes thought; then organization of that
thought into ideas and plans; then transformation
of those plans into reality. The beginning, as you
will observe, is in your imagination.

The great successful men of the world have used
their imaginations ... they think ahead and create
their mental picture, and then go to work materializing
that picture in all its details, filling in here,
adding a little there, altering this a bit and that
a bit, but steadily building - steadily building.

Make every thought, every fact, that comes into your
mind pay you a profit. Make it work and produce for
you. Think of things not as they are but as they might
be ... Don't merely dream - but create!

We are told never to cross a bridge till we come
to it, but this world is owned by the men who have
crossed bridges in their imagination far ahead of the crowd.

My method is different. I do not rush into actual work.
When I get a new idea, I start at once building it up
in my imagination, and make improvements and operate
the device in my mind ... When I have gone so far as
to embody everything in my invention, every possible
improvement I can think of, and when I see no fault
anywhere, I put into concrete form the final product of my brain.

I am thought.
I can see what the eyes cannot see.
I can hear what the ears cannot hear.
I can feel what the heart cannot feel.

I notice an almost universal trait among Super
Achievers, and it was what I call Sensory Goal
Vision. These people knew what they wanted out
of life, and they could sense it multidimensionally
before they ever had it. They could not only see it,
but also taste it, smell it, and imagine the sounds
and emotions associated with it. They pre-lived
it before they had it. And that sharp, sensory
vision became a powerful driving force in their lives.



Chapter 34

Motion

The courage to begin separates dreamers from achievers.
Starting is the key: because if we want to be successful,
we must start sometime. The willingness to act - to
overcome inertia - is the first step on the path to greatness.

That's why many fail - because they don't get
started - they don't go. They don't overcome inertia. They don't begin.

There are those of us who are always about to live.

We are waiting until things change, until there is more time, until we are less tired, until we get a promotion, until we settle down - until, until, until. It always seems as if there is some major event that must occur in our lives before we begin living.

Nothing will ever be attempted if all possible objections must first be overcome.

It is our attitude at the beginning of a difficult task which, more than anything else, will affect its successful outcome.

It is impossible to win the race unless you venture to run, impossible to win the victory unless you dare to battle.

Do not wait; the time will never be just right. Start where you stand, and work with whatever tools you may have at your command, and better tools will be found as you go along.

The great thing is the start - to see an opportunity for service, and to start doing it, even though in the beginning you serve but a single customer - and him for nothing.

Everyone who achieves success in a great venture, solved each problem as they came to it. They helped themselves. And they were helped through powers known

and unknown to them at the time they set out on their voyage.
They kept going regardless of the obstacles they met.



Chapter 35

Love

Love is the most important ingredient of success.
Without it, our life echoes emptiness. With it,
our life vibrates warmth and meaning. Even in
hardship, love shines through. Therefore, search for love.
Once we have learned to love, we will have learned to live.

Do not shut love out of your life by saying it is impossible to find.
The quickest way to receive love is to give love;
The fastest way to lose love is to hold it too tightly;
In addition, the best way to keep love is to give it wings.

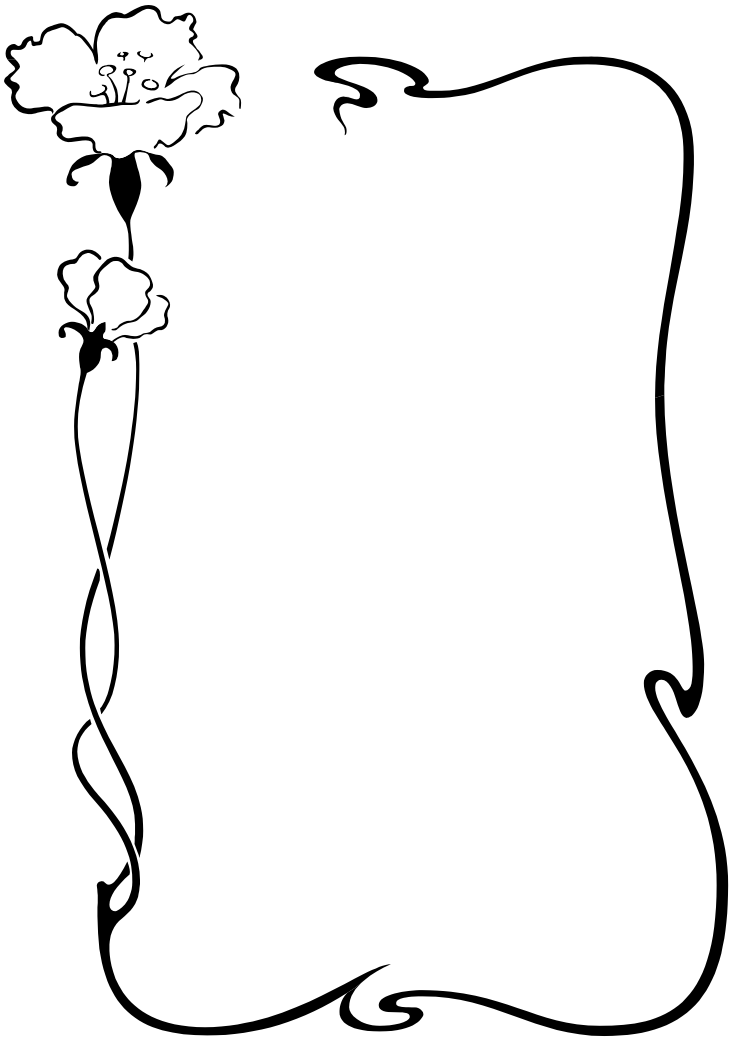
No thoughtful man ever came to the end of his life,
and had time and a little space of calm from which
to look back upon it, who did not know and acknowledge
that it was what he had done unselfishly and for
others, and nothing else, that satisfied him in the
retrospect, and made him feel that he had played the man.

You will find as you look back upon your life that the
moments that stand out, the moments when you have really lived,
are the moments when you have done things in a spirit of love.

Love is the only bow on life's dark cloud. It is the
Morning and Evening Star. It shines upon the cradle
of the babe, and sheds its radiance upon the quiet
tomb. It is the Mother of Art, inspirer of poet,
patriot, and philosopher. It is the air and light
of every heart, builder of every home, kindler of
every fire on every hearth. It was the first dream
of immortality. It fills the world with melody ....
Love is the magician, the enchanter, that changes worthless
things to joy, and makes right royal kings of common clay.

Love means the body, the soul, the life, the entire
being. We feel love as we feel the warmth of our
blood, we breathe love as we breathe the air, we
hold it in ourselves as we hold our thoughts.
Nothing more exists for us.

Once you have learned to love,
You will have learned to live.



Chapter 36

Impetus

Focused attitude keeps us going. To be continually working is not enough. We must see clearly the next step. To keep moving after achieving one goal, we must set a new one. The key to momentum is always having something to look forward to.

People who say that life is not worthwhile are really saying that they themselves have no personal goals which are worthwhile ... Get yourself a goal worth working for. Better still, get yourself a

project ... Always have something ahead of you to look forward to - to work for and hope for.

Man was created as a being who should constantly keep improving, a being who on reaching one goal sets a higher one.



Chapter 37

Resources

Money is a tool much like a fluid which flows in a manner governed by the controlling operative. Money flows to an idea. And all riches begin in the mind. The starting point is to see what others want and to think of how to provide it. People will pay for a product or service they want. The idea will attract the money which follows. You can think and grow rich with money flowing per your directive.

Thought, not money, is the real business capital...

All achievement, all earned riches, have their beginning in an idea.

Thought is the original source of all wealth,
all success, all material gain, all great discoveries
and inventions, and of all achievement.

More gold has been mined from the thoughts of men
than has ever been taken from the earth.

The basic principle of turning ideas into big money
is to seize every money building idea and work with
it until the idea fits your purpose, decide on the
steps needed to make it work, and then proceed to do
it as soon as possible.

Chapter 38

Motivation

We are motivated to the degree that the decisions
we make are our decisions. To be honest with
ourselves, to sincerely know what we really want,
is the key to motivation. We are always in a
position to decide. We can decide to do something
or we can decide to do nothing. The choice is ours.

You can choose to be lazy or you can choose to be ambitious.
Stop to think about it again. Don't you do your own choosing?

We may think there is willpower involved, but more
likely ... change is due to want power. Wanting the
new addiction more than the old one. Wanting the new
me in preference to the ... person I am now.

It's so hard when I have to,
And so easy when I want to.

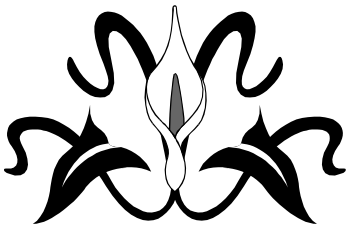
There is only one way ... to get anybody to do anything ...
And that is by making the other person want to do it.

Self-observation brings man to the realization
of the necessity of self-change. And in observing
himself a man notices that self-observation itself
brings about certain changes in his inner processes.
He begins to understand that self-observation is an
instrument of self-change, a means of awakening.

Successful people have cultivated the habit of
never denying to themselves their true feelings
and attitudes ... They have no need for pretenses.

Any person who recognizes this greatest power ....
the power to choose ... Begins to realize that he
is the one that is doing the choosing and that
friends, although they mean well, cannot do his
choosing for him, nor can his relatives.
Consequently, he develops real self-confidence
based upon his own ability, upon his own actions,
and upon his own initiative.

First say to yourself what you would be; and then
do what you have to do.



Chapter 39

Opportunity

We develop opportunity by applying persistence to
the possibilities. Opportunity is all around us.
If we seek it, we will find it. And if the door
of opportunity is closed, we must knock on it -
and keep on knocking until it opens.

Opportunity rarely knocks on your door. Knock rather
on opportunity's door if you ardently wish to enter.

The lack of opportunity is ever the excuse of
a weak, vacillating mind. Opportunities! Every
life is full of them ... Every newspaper article
is an opportunity. Every client is an opportunity.
Every sermon is an opportunity. Every business
transaction is an opportunity, - an opportunity
to be polite, - an opportunity to be manly, -
an opportunity to be honest, - an opportunity
to make friends.

The golden opportunity you are seeking is in
yourself. It is not in your environment; it is
not in luck or chance, or the help of others;
it is in yourself alone.

There are always opportunities through which
businessmen can profit handsomely if they will
only recognize and seize them ...

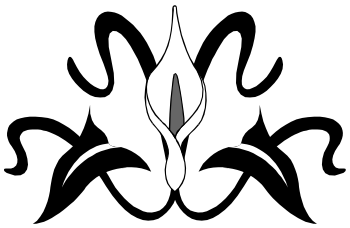
There is no future in any job. The future lies
in the man who holds the job.

Start where you are. Distant fields always look
greener, but opportunity lies right where you are.
Take advantage of every opportunity of service.

Opportunity ... Often it comes disguised in the
form of misfortune, or temporary defeat.

Each problem has hidden in it an opportunity
so powerful that it literally dwarfs the problem.
The greatest success stories were created by people
who recognized a problem and turned it into an opportunity.

The people who get on in this world are the people
who get up and look for the circumstances they want,
and, if they can't find them, make them.



Chapter 40

Harmony

Peace comes when we live in a spirit of love. To get
along with others, we must love them without forcing
our love upon them. Imposing our beliefs upon others
will not bring peace. To have concern for others,
to respect their rights and freedoms, and to let
them be themselves - this is peace.

Consideration for others is the basis of a good life, a good society.

It is understanding that gives us an ability to have
peace. When we understand the other fellow's viewpoint, and he
understands ours, then we can sit down and work out our differences.

We look forward to the time when the Power of Love will replace
the Love of Power. Then will our world know the blessing of Peace.

War grows out of the desire of the individual to gain
advantage at the expense of his fellow men ...

There are weapons that are simply thoughts ...
For the record, prejudices can kill and suspicion can destroy ...

The only way to have a friend is to be one.

For one human being to love another: that is perhaps
the most difficult of all our tasks, the ultimate, the last test
and proof, the work for which all other work is but preparation.

Even when I have a pain, I don't have to be one.

Chapter 41

Persistence

The power to hold on in spite of everything,
to endure - this is the winner's quality.
Persistence is the ability to face defeat again
and again without giving up - to push on in
the face of great difficulty. Persistence means
taking pains to overcome every obstacle, to do
all that's necessary to reach our goals.

The reasonable man adapts himself to the world:
the unreasonable one persists in trying to adapt the world
to himself. Therefore all progress depends on the unreasonable man.

If I had to select one quality, one personal
characteristic that I regard as being most highly
correlated with success, whatever the field,
I would pick the trait of persistence. Determination.
The will to endure to the end, to get knocked
down seventy times and get up off the floor
saying, Here goes number seventy-one!

I do not think there is any other quality so
essential to success of any kind as the quality
of perseverance. It overcomes almost everything,
even nature.

Nothing in the world can take the place of
persistence. Talent will not; nothing is more
common than unsuccessful men with talent.
Genius will not; unrewarded genius is almost
a proverb. Education will not; the world is

full of educated derelicts. Persistence and determination alone are omnipotent.

Before success comes in any man's life he is sure to meet with much temporary defeat and, perhaps, some failure. When defeat overtakes a man, the easiest and most logical thing to do is to quit. That is exactly what the majority of men do.

What this power is I cannot say; all I know is that it exists and it becomes available only when a man is in that state of mind in which he knows exactly what he wants and is fully determined not to quit until he finds it.

When you get right down to the root of the meaning of the word succeed, you find that it simply means to follow through.

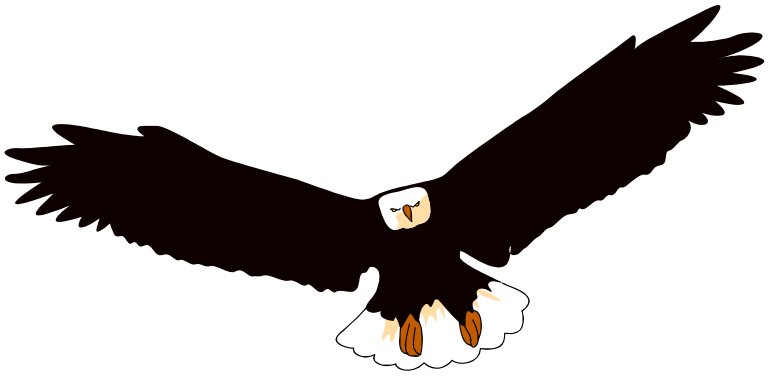
Our greatest glory is not in never falling, but in rising every time we fall.

The majority of men meet with failure because of their lack of persistence in creating new plans to take the place of those which fail.

A man is not finished when he's defeated; he's finished when he quits.

In each age men of genius undertake the ascent.
From below, the world follows them with their eyes.
These men go up the mountain, enter the clouds,
disappear, reappear. People watch them, mark them.
They walk by the side of precipices. They daringly
pursue their road. See them aloft, see them in the
distance; they are but black specks. On they go.
The road is uneven, its difficulties constant.
At each step a wall, at each step a trap. As they
rise the cold increases. They must make their
ladder, cut the ice and walk on it, hewing the
steps in haste. A storm is raging. Nevertheless
they go forward in their madness. The air becomes
difficult to breathe. The abyss yawns below them.
Some fall. Others stop and retrace their steps;
there is a sad weariness.

The bold ones continue. They are eyed by the eagles;
the lightning plays about them; the hurricane is
furious. No matter, they persevere.



Chapter 42

Planning

Planning is the power tool for achievement –
the magic bridge to our goal. Planning is like a road map.
It can show us the way, head us in the right direction,
and keep us on course. Planning means mapping out
how to get from where we are now to where we want to be.

The task of the leader is to get his people from where
they are to where they have not been.

No one was ever lost on a straight road.

Reduce your plan to writing ... The moment you
complete this, you will have definitely given concrete
form to the intangible desire.

First you write down your goal; your second job
is to break down your goal into a series of steps,
beginning with steps which are absurdly easy.

Chapter 43

Dreams

There are no limits to our possibilities.
At any moment, we have more opportunities than
we can act upon. When we imagine our dreams,
our vision expands, we capture our passion, and our
life is full. We can reach out and touch the limits of our being.

Do not dismiss your dreams.
To be without dreams
is to be without hope;
To be without hope
is to be without purpose.

There is far more opportunity than there is ability.

Deep within man dwell those slumbering powers;
powers that would astonish him, that he never
dreamed of possessing; forces that would
revolutionize his life if aroused and put into action.

When the impossible has been eliminated, whatever
remains, no matter how improbable ... is possible.

The failure wishes he could do things he could
never do. He thinks little of what he can do.

Chapter 44

Worth

Self worth comes from knowing how to do something.
Confident people are people who know how to get
things done. Sometimes knowing how to do
something is virtually the same as having done it.

So when we educate ourselves, we build value in ourselves which empowers us to accomplish our goals.

Do not undermine your worth by comparing yourself with others. It is because we are different that each of us is special.

Power gravitates to the man who knows how.

The king is the man who can.

To know the right means of getting something done is virtually to have done it.

As a general rule the most successful man in life is the man who has the best information.

To succeed in a business, to reach the top, an individual must know all it is possible to know about that business.

A knowledge of men is the prime secret of business success.

Chapter 45

Praise

As water is to flowers - so is praise to the heart of man. We thrive on being appreciated, loved and needed. When we make others feel important, and show them respect and praise, they do their best. Nothing stimulates growth so much as praise. Whatever we praise, we increase.

We increase whatever we praise. The whole creation responds to praise, and is glad.

To say, well done to any bit of good work is to take hold of the powers which have made the effort and strengthen them beyond our knowledge!

The deepest principle in human nature is the craving to be appreciated.

If human beings are perceived as potentials rather than problems, as possessing strengths instead of weakness, as unlimited rather than dull and unresponsive, then they thrive and grow to their capabilities.

We are all motivated by a keen desire for praise, and the better a man is, the more he is inspired by glory. The very philosophers themselves, even in those books which they write in contempt of glory, inscribe their names.

There is no investment you can make which will pay you so well as the effort to scatter sunshine and good cheer through your establishment.



Chapter 46

Expense

Everything has a price. Whatever we want in life, we must give up something to get it. The greater the value, the greater the sacrifice required. There is a high price to pay for success. But we must realize that the rewards of true success are well worth the effort. The highway to success is a toll road.

Nature cannot be tricked or cheated. She will give up to you the object of your struggles only after you have paid her price.

Success is the child of drudgery and perseverance.
It cannot be coaxed or bribed; pay the price and it is yours.

Labor is still, and ever will be, the inevitable
price set upon everything which is valuable.

Everything you want in life has a price connected
to it. There's a price to pay if you want to make
things better, a price to pay just for leaving things
as they are, a price for everything.

There is no royal road; you've got to work a good
deal harder than most people want to work.

Nothing worthwhile comes easily ...
Work, continuous work, hard work,
is the only way to accomplish results that last.

Chapter 47

Responsibility

The power to fulfill our dreams is within each of us.
We alone have the responsibility to shape our lives.
When we understand this, we know that nothing, and no
one, can deny us greatness. We are the ones pushing
ourselves forward or holding ourselves back. The power
to succeed or fail is ours alone.

We have forty million reasons for failure, but not a single excuse.

Some men have thousands of reasons why they cannot
do what they want to, when all they need is one
reason why they can.

In the last analysis, the individual person
is responsible for living his own life and for
finding himself. If he persists in shifting
his responsibility to somebody else, he fails
to find out the meaning of his own existence.

Success on any major scale requires you to accept
responsibility ... In the final analysis, the one
quality that all successful people have ... is the
ability to take on responsibility.

Hold yourself responsible for a higher
standard than anybody else expects of you.
Never excuse yourself.

You might well remember that nothing can bring
you success but yourself.

More powerful than all the success slogans ever
penned by human hand is the realization for every
man that he has but one boss. That boss is the
man himself.

I guess more players lick themselves than are ever
licked by an opposing team. The first thing any man
has to know is how to handle himself.



Chapter 48

Protection

We are secure to the degree that we can accept change.
Security comes from being able to bend - insecurity,
from breaking when things don't go our way. Those who
are most secure are best able to accept change. Not by standing still,
but by growing, moving, being energized, do we become secure.

Security ... It's simply the recognition that changes
will take place and the knowledge that you're willing
to deal with whatever happens.

One has to abandon altogether the search for
security, and reach out to the risk of living with
both arms ... One has to court doubt and darkness
as the cost of knowing. One needs a will stubborn

in conflict, but apt always to total acceptance
of every consequence of living and dying.

We must be steady enough in ourselves, to be open
and to let the winds of life blow through us,
to be our breath, our inspiration; to breathe
with them, mobile and soft in the limberness
of our bodies, in our agility, our ability,
as it were, to dance, and yet to stand upright ...

Security depends not so much upon how much you
have, as upon how much you can do without.

The ultimate security is your understanding of reality.

It is when we all play safe that we create a world of utmost insecurity.

Playing safe is probably the most unsafe thing in the world.
You cannot stand still. You must go forward ....

There is no security on this earth; there is only opportunity.



Chapter 49

Service

No one achieves greatness without being of service.
Service is the essence of greatness. All great men
and women became great because they gave some talent
or ability in the service of others. And no matter
how small our talent, we too can contribute in some
way to others - we too can become great.

No person was ever honored for what he received;
honor has been the reward for what he gave.

The measure of a man is ... in the number of people whom he serves.

The high destiny of the individual is to serve rather than to rule ...

No man has ever risen to the real stature of
spiritual manhood until he has found that it is
finer to serve somebody else than it is to serve himself.

There is no higher religion than human service.
To work for the common good is the greatest creed.

He is the richest man who enriches his country most;
in whom the people feel richest and proudest; who
gives himself with his money; who opens the door of
opportunity widest to those about him; who is ears
to the deaf, eyes to the blind, and feet to the lame.
Such a man makes every acre of land in his community
worth more, and makes richer every man who lives near him.

No enterprise can exist for itself alone.
It ministers to some great need, it performs some
great service, not for itself, but for others; or failing
therein, it ceases to be profitable and ceases to exist.

The golden rule for every business man is this:
Put yourself in your customer's place.



Chapter 50

Purity

By understanding the simple, we can understand the complex. We increase our understanding of any subject by progressing from the pure to the complicated. When we divide the complex into simple parts, and master them, no project is too difficult. The key to mastery is purity and simplicity.

Order and simplification are the first steps toward the mastery of a subject ....

All great truths are simple in final analysis, and easily understood; if they are not, they are not great truths.

A complex system that works is invariably found to have evolved from a simple system that works.

Every contrivance of man, every tool, every instrument, every utensil, every article designed for use, of each and every kind, evolved from very simple beginnings ...

It is a simple task to make things complex, but a complex task to make them simple.

Nature is an endless combination and repetition of a very few laws.

Nothing is particularly hard if you divide it into small jobs.

Life is really simple, but men insist on making it complicated.

Our life is frittered away by detail ... Simplify, simplify.

See it big, and keep it simple.

The wisest ... keeps something of the vision of
a child. Though he may think a thousand things that
a child could not understand, he is always a beginner,
close to the original meaning of life.



Chapter 51

Success

Success means doing the best we can with what we have.
Success is in the doing, not the getting - in the
trying, not the triumph. Success is a personal standard -
reaching for the highest that is in us - becoming all
that we can be. If we do our best, we are a success.

The greatest thing a man can do in this world is to
make the most possible out of the stuff that has been
given to him. This is success, and there is no other.

Success has always been easy to measure. It is
the distance between one's origins and one's final achievement ....

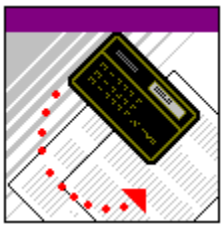
No matter what you do, do it to your utmost ...
I always attribute my success ... to always requiring
myself to do my level best, if only in driving a tack in straight.

I think that at some point in your life you realize
you don't have to worry if you do everything you're
supposed to do right. Or if not right, if you do it
the best you can ... what can worry do for you?
You are already doing the best you can.
Make the most of yourself, for that is all there is of you.

If a man has a talent and cannot use it, he has
failed. If he has a talent and uses only half of
it, he has partly failed. If he has a talent and
learns somehow to use the whole of it, he has
gloriously succeeded, and won a satisfaction
and a triumph few men ever know.

It has always been my belief that a man should
do his best, regardless of how much he receives
for his services, or the number of people he
may be serving or the class of people served.

Determine to become one of the best .... Sufficient
money will almost automatically follow if you get
to be one of the best in your chosen field, whatever it is.



Chapter 52

Implication

A change in what we tell ourselves will result in a change in our behavior. Positive, repetitive self-talk changes our self image. And the suggestions we offer to ourselves will be expressed in our actions. What we impress upon our minds, we inevitably become.

Every waking moment we talk to ourselves about the things we experience. Our self-talk, the thoughts we communicate to ourselves, in turn control the way we feel and act.

The self-image is the key to human personality and human behavior. Change the self image and you change the personality and the behavior.

To begin with, you must realize that any idea accepted by the brain is automatically transformed into an action of some sort. It may take seconds or minutes or longer - but ideas always produce a reaction of some sort.

Any idea, plan, or purpose may be placed in the mind through repetition of thought.

Only one thing registers on the subconscious mind; repetitive application - practice. What you practice is what you manifest.

As long as you know what it is you desire, then by simply affirming that it is yours - firmly and positively, with no ifs, buts, or maybes - over and over again, from the minute you arise in the morning until the time you go to sleep at night, and as many times during the day as your work or activities permit, you will be drawn to those people, places, and events that will bring your desires to you.

Your ability to use the principle of autosuggestion will depend, very largely, upon your capacity to concentrate upon a given desire until that desire becomes a burning obsession.



Chapter 53

Duration

Time can't be managed. But what can be managed are
our activities and how we spend time. And all the
experts agree: managing our activities begins with
planning. So by knowing what's important for us - planning

our work and working our plan - we become wise time managers.

Do not let your life slip through your fingers
by living in the past nor for the future. By living
your life one day at a time, you live all the days of your life.

We realize our dilemma goes deeper than shortage
of time; it is basically a problem of priorities ...
We confess ... 'We have left undone those things
that we ought to have done; and we have done those
things which we ought not to have done.'

Set priorities for your goals ... A major part
of successful living lies in the ability to put
first things first. Indeed, the reason most major
goals are not achieved is that we spend our time
doing second things first.

The key to setting priorities, the order in which
you must accomplish things, is to ask yourself,
"What is my payoff in doing this activity? How does
this fit in with my long-term objectives ... ?"

What do you want to get done? ...
In what order of importance? ...
Over what period of time? ...
What is the time available? ...
What is the best strategy for application of time
to projects for the most effective results?

Plan your work for today and every day, then
work your plan.

Write down the most important things you have to do tomorrow. Now, number them in the order of their true importance. The first thing tomorrow morning, start working on item Number 1, and stay with it until completed. Then take item Number 2 the same way. Then Number 3, and so on. Don't worry if you don't complete everything on the schedule. At least you will have completed the most important projects before getting to the less important ones.



Chapter 54

Truth

Truth exists... Truth is neither good nor bad, ugly nor beautiful. Truth is just what is here and now - it is reality. The Successful are realists.
They are not trapped by false appearances.
They see the world as it is.

Reality isn't the way you wish things to be, nor the
way they appear to be, but the way they actually are.

The truth has a million faces, but there is only one truth.

Nature never deceives us; it is we who deceive ourselves.

If fifty million people say a foolish thing, it is still a foolish thing.

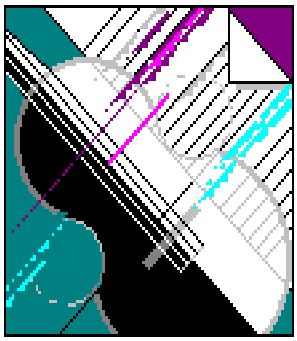
The fact that an opinion has been widely held
is no evidence whatever that it is not utterly absurd ....

No matter what you believe, it doesn't change the facts.

Truth will always be truth, regardless of lack
of understanding, disbelief or ignorance.

We must learn to tailor our concepts to fit reality,
instead of trying to stuff reality into our concepts.

Sit down before fact like a little child, and
be prepared to give up every preconceived notion,
follow humbly wherever and to whatever abyss Nature
leads, or you shall learn nothing.



Chapter 55

Insight

We have understanding to the degree that we see how things change. Seeing the flow of events and how history develops, gives us understanding. Seeing what has gone before gives insight into what may be.

We can chart our future clearly and wisely only when we know the path which has led to the present.

The farther backward you can look, the farther
forward you are likely to see.

Time is the wisest counselor.

Chapter 56

Foresight

Vision is the gift of seeing clearly what may be.
Vision expands our horizons. The more we see,
the more we can achieve; the grander our vision,
the more glorious our accomplishment. The courage
to follow our dreams is the first step toward destiny.

The more you can dream, the more you can do.

I was once asked if a big business man ever reached
his objective. I replied that if a man ever reached
his objective he was not a big business man.

Vision ... It reaches beyond the thing that is,
into the conception of what can be. Imagination
gives you the picture. Vision gives you the impulse
to make the picture your own.

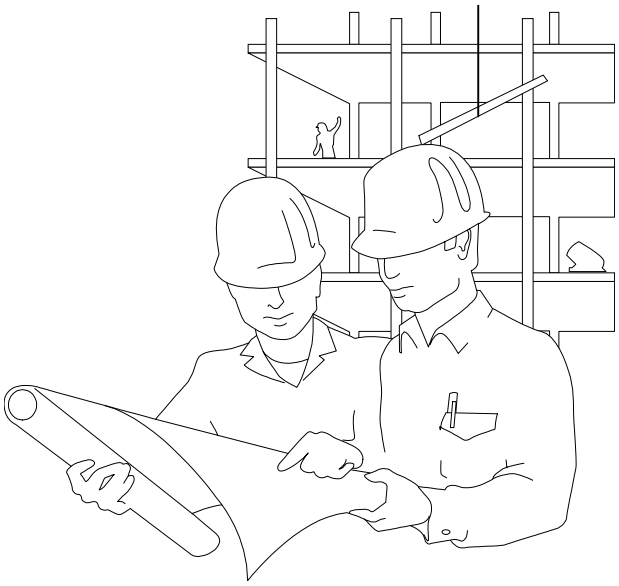
We lift ourselves by our thought, we climb upon
our vision of ourselves. If you want to enlarge your
life, you must first enlarge your thought of it and
of yourself. Hold the ideal of yourself as you long
to be, always, everywhere - your ideal of what you
long to attain - the ideal of health, efficiency, success.

The idea for which this nation stands will not
survive if the highest goal free man can set themselves
is an amiable mediocrity ... Excellence implies ...
Striving for the highest standard in every phase of life.

The only way to discover the limits of the possible
is to go beyond them into the impossible.

Man's mind stretched to a new idea never goes back
to its original dimensions.

Man, alone, has the power to transform his thoughts
into physical reality; man, alone, can dream and
make his dreams come true.



Chapter 57

Wisdom

Wisdom comes from the experience of living. To travel the road of wisdom requires knowledge of ourselves and others - in love and hatred, in joy and sorrow, in victory and defeat. To experience life, and to learn its truth - this is wisdom.

There are many truths of which the full meaning cannot be realized until personal experience has brought it home.

You know more of a road by having traveled it than by all the conjectures and descriptions in the world.

I have known it for a long time but I have only just experienced it. Now I know it not only with my

intellect, but with my eyes, with my heart, with my stomach.

I hear and I forget. I see and I remember. I do and I understand.

Knowledge conquered by labor becomes a possession - a property entirely our own.

Knowledge comes, but wisdom lingers. It may not be difficult to store up in the mind a vast quantity of facts within a comparatively short time, but the ability to form judgments requires the severe discipline of hard work and the tempering heat of experience and maturity.

The universe is one great kindergarten for man. Everything that exists has brought with it its own peculiar lesson. The mountain teaches stability and grandeur; the ocean immensity and change. Forests, lakes, and rivers, clouds and winds, stars and flowers, stupendous glaciers and crystal snowflakes, every form of animate or inanimate existence, leaves its impress upon the soul of man. Even the bee and ant have brought their little lessons of industry and economy.